WARNING SIGNS CARD

Head injury in a child

Your child hit their head

Call 112 or 108 now

- Unconscious, or very hard to wake
- A fit (seizure)
- Weakness in an arm or leg
- Clear fluid or blood from the nose or ears
- A dent in the skull or a deep wound

Go to hospital today

- Knocked out, even for a few seconds
- Vomited after the injury
- Headache that keeps getting worse
- Confused, very sleepy, or not acting like themselves
- Can't remember what happened
- Trouble walking, seeing or talking
- A baby under 1 with a large swelling or bruise on the head

Caring at home

- Put a cold pack wrapped in a cloth on the bump
- Give paracetamol if needed
- Let them sleep, but check they wake easily and know you
- Watch closely for the next 48 hours
- No rough play or contact sport until a doctor says it is safe

Emergency: 112 · Ambulance: 108

Based on NICE guideline NG232, Head injury (2023), and NHS advice for parents. General information, not personal medical advice. Checked November 2026.

Insula Neurosciences